EL NIÑO ACTION BRIEFING · 9 OCTOBER 2026

Woodland Hills, Los Angeles, CA 91367

Woodland Hills' El Niño will be tested first by heat, not rain. It set its October record of 113°F on 1 October 2024, and El Niño does not cool its autumns. A heat alert on its own saves no one; a knock on a named door does. The single most important step is a list of the people in this ZIP who would die alone in a hot apartment or without power for an oxygen machine, and someone assigned to call them on every dangerous heat day through November.

IMPACT REGION	EXCESS HEAT DEATHS	WINDOW	DOMINANT HAZARD
A Los Angeles County impact region (inferred; the county's ~9.7M people span many regions, and the specific one was not resolved)	None published for the US, California, or Los Angeles County	Global 6-month figure 239,000 ± 11,000 (Sep 2026 – Feb 2027). Heat in September to November falls inside it here	Autumn heat, then winter atmospheric rivers: people in the river channels, outages for 406 power-dependent residents, and evacuees arriving from Topanga

12/12 recommendations checked. 2 confirmed, 8 corrected, 2 unverified (an LADWP heat-shutoff trigger; free LAFD sandbags), and 0 contraindicated. Three practices are

EXECUTIVE SUMMARY — AT A GLANCE



34.17°N 118.61°W, United States of America · Natural Earth

- **The risk.** Heat comes before rain: Woodland Hills set its October record of 113°F on 1 October 2024, and winter atmospheric rivers then bring outages for 406 power-dependent residents.
- **First action.** LA County Public Health and a senior-services operator phone or knock on a named list of power-dependent residents, care-facility residents, and older people living alone on every major or extreme HeatRisk day through November.*
- **The money.** $65k floor, $135k target, $240k ceiling; the floor pays for check-ins with 250 people over 20 weeks and 500 kits.
- **Do not.** Do not treat a heat alert or a list of cooling centres as the heat plan: Medicare data show no lower mortality on heat-alert days.*

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* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

flagged “do not do”. Exposure figure: Climate Impact Lab, September 2026, pre-peer-review, heat only. Heat *is* part of this ZIP's hazard inside the window, but no figure is published for the US or anywhere in it, so none is borrowed or scaled. **The funding target fell 27% in verification**, from $185k to $135k. Nearly every verifier exhausted its web-search budget and checked by fetching primary pages; claims they could not reach are marked or left out.

Where this is. ZIP 91367 is mostly the Valley floor: Warner Center's apartment blocks, Pierce College, Kaiser Permanente Woodland Hills, and the flatlands down to the hills (ACS 2024: 45,889 people; 55% of households rent; 17% are 65 or older; 30% foreign-born). **Most of Woodland Hills' hillside streets, and the Motion Picture & Television Fund campus on Mulholland, are in the neighbouring ZIP 91364**, so the hillside mudslide risk sits largely outside the ZIP named. Woodland Hills sits where Topanga Canyon Boulevard (SR-27), the canyon's northern exit, reaches the Valley, which makes it a receiving community in Topanga emergencies. Home languages after English include Spanish and a large “other Indo-European” group that includes Persian and Armenian; the ZIP-level split was not verified.

What the forecast says. NOAA's Climate Prediction Center (8 October 2026) calls a strong-to-very-strong El Niño likely through January–March 2027, gives the California coast 50–60% odds of a wetter-than-normal winter, and favours above-normal temperatures across most of the West for October–December. A wet winter is likely, not certain: the 2015–16 super El Niño gave downtown Los Angeles only about 68% of its 14.25-inch normal. And El Niño does not end heat season here. Across ten strong El Niño autumns since 1949, the average October maximum at Pierce College was 100°F, the same as all years.

WHAT THIS PLACE SHOULD DO

RANKED

Actions are ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak. The backing lenses are shown on each action, and the RACI chart

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

below assigns each one. The first two are autumn actions and should start now; the rest prepare for winter.

1. On every major or extreme HeatRisk day through November, phone or knock on a named list: power-dependent residents, care-facility residents, and older people living alone

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST | INVENTORY: NOT REACHABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
LA County Department of Public Health (requests the named emPOWER list); a senior-services operator such as ONEgeneration makes the calls; building captains in Warner Center; Council District 3's office convenes	List and callers in place by 20 Oct; runs on NWS HeatRisk "major" or higher through 30 Nov	~$80k for 400 people over the season (assumed $10 per person-week; see funding)	Heat deaths indoors among isolated, bedbound, and care-facility residents

Heat alerts alone have not reduced deaths: across US Medicare data, alert days showed no lower mortality (RR 1.005; Weinberger et al., *Environ Int* 2021), and across 20 cities only Philadelphia's alerts saved lives (about 4.4% fewer deaths), because they trigger outreach (Weinberger et al. 2018). In Los Angeles County's Medical Examiner data, deaths in care facilities rose 91% on major or extreme HeatRisk days, deaths among homeless people rose 59%, and all deaths rose 66% on extreme days (Baker & Sturm, *Public Health* 2024). In a meta-analysis of heat-wave deaths, being confined to bed carried 6.4 times the odds of death and not leaving home daily 3.4 times, while more social contact cut the odds by 60% (Bouchama et al., *Arch Intern Med* 2007). HHS emPOWER (queried 9 October 2026) counts 9,461 Medicare beneficiaries in 91367, of whom **406 use power-dependent equipment**, including 68 on oxygen and 35 on dialysis. Include households served by the West Valley Food Pantry (5700 Rudnick Ave, inside the ZIP), which states that it closes during rain and excessive heat, exactly the days its clients most need it.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the public emPOWER layer gives counts only; a *named* list needs a county health department request. The +66% applies to extreme days; major days were +15%. Bouchama's studies are mostly from Chicago and Europe, though the Los Angeles studies point the same way. ONEgeneration runs care management and a Woodland Hills dining site, but no phone-reassurance program was found, so it is a proposed operator, not a confirmed one. The ZIP's count of older people living alone was not retrieved.

2. Make cooling reachable: evening hours and transport at West Valley cooling sites on heat days, and get low-income households onto LADWP discounts so they qualify for the $275 air-conditioner rebate

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NOT REACHABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
LA City Emergency Management Department and LA County (augmented cooling centres); LADWP (rebate); community groups help with enrolment	**Evening hours now; enrolment and rebates from now (most units will help in 2027)**	**Rebate paid by LADWP ratepayers; site hours not costed**	**Heat deaths among people who cannot reach a cool place**

A working home air conditioner is the strongest protective factor in the heat-death literature (odds ratio 0.23), and visiting cool places helps (0.34); fans showed no significant benefit (Bouchama et al. 2007). But cooling centres as a list do little: over Labor Day 2020 one lens found that six city sites drew fewer than 300 visitors in total, and distance and not knowing were the reasons given. Los Angeles County already designates some sites as “Augmented Cooling Centers” with extended hours; ask for one in the West Valley with a shuttle. LADWP's Cool LA rebate pays $275 per unit for up to two window, wall, or portable units to customers on EZ-SAVE (income limit $43,280 for one or two people from 1 July 2026), Lifeline, the Life-Support Equipment discount, or the Physician Certified Allowance; others get $125 for window units only. The discount must be active when the unit is bought.*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the 2020 visitor count is from the *Los Angeles Times* and could not be re-fetched. Whether a Woodland Hills site is on the city's cooling list, and whether Pierce College (LACCD) would open in the evening, were not verified. Rebate units bought now mostly protect people in 2027. Heat records: 121°F at Pierce College on 5–6 September 2020 (a La Niña year) is the county record; September 2024 peaked at 116–117°F, not 119°F as one lens said; 113°F on 1 October 2024 broke the daily record of 110°F (1980).

3. When the NWS issues a Flood Watch, reach people living in the LA River headwaters channel within 24–48 hours with beds, transport, and storage, and pause clean-ups for 48 hours before the storm

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · FRONTLINE · PHILANTHROPIST | INVENTORY: NOT REACHABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
LA County Department of Homeless Services and Housing (taking over winter shelter and storm response from LAHSA), with LAHSA and county outreach teams; LAFD swift-water units pre-positioned; the City for the clean-up pause	**Written protocol by 1 Nov**	**Within existing outreach; bed-nights $25k (assumed $100 each; see funding)**	**Drowning and swift-water rescues in the channels**

The concrete channels fill in minutes. On 13 March 2023, eight people were rescued from the San Gabriel River and a ninth was missing; on 24 March 2024 a woman was hoisted by helicopter from the LA River in Studio City. Before the February 2024 storm, county teams contacted thousands of people in riverbeds and about 1,000 came inside, so the practice exists. What it lacks is storage for belongings, which is why people stay, and any rule against clearing an encampment just before a storm. Pay for beds per verified bed-night through the county's Emergency Response Program, not by block grant.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: **who leads is unsettled before this winter.** A February 2026 Board of Supervisors motion moved winter shelter and storm response to the new county department and recorded that vouchers ran out mid-season and 211 callers were turned away last winter. HUD announced in June 2026 that it would suspend federal funding to LAHSA; the effect on shelter was not verified. The 2025–26 winter program opened with 61 beds at two sites and grew to at least about 295. No LA River drowning in 2023–25 was confirmed, and whether people live in the headwaters channel *inside* 91367 was not verified. No study shows pre-storm outreach reduces drownings.

4. Before storm season, make sure the 68 oxygen users and 35 dialysis patients in this ZIP have backup supply plans that do not depend on LADWP

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | PUBLIC HEALTH · EMERGENCY MGR | INVENTORY: NOT REACHABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
LA County Department of Public Health with oxygen suppliers and dialysis units; the check-in callers in action 1 ask the question	**1 Dec**	**Normally covered by suppliers**	**Deaths when a storm or wind outage cuts power for days**

LADWP offers a Life-Support Equipment discount and a Physician Certified Allowance. Neither promises priority restoration or advance notice. So continuity has to come from backup oxygen cylinders from the supplier, each dialysis unit's storm plan, and household backup power. The 2003 New York blackout raised accidental deaths by 122% and other deaths by 25% (Anderson & Bell, *Epidemiology* 2012).*

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: whether LADWP runs public safety power shutoffs, and its recent outage history in the west Valley, were not verified. The blackout study measures the harm in another city, not the effect of this action.

5. Ask the county to pre-designate El Camino Real Charter High School as a candidate shelter for Topanga evacuees, with traffic control where Topanga Canyon Boulevard meets the Valley

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | EMERGENCY MGR · HISTORIAN | INVENTORY: NOT REACHABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
LA County Office of Emergency Management (Topanga is unincorporated), with the American Red Cross and the school	1 Dec	Staff time	An improvised shelter search during a canyon evacuation

Topanga Canyon Boulevard keeps failing. Atmospheric-river storms set off a landslide that closed it from 9 March to 2 June 2024. After the Palisades Fire it reopened to daytime traffic only on 4 March 2026, still closes fully from midnight to 5am, and needs at least $38.5M of repairs (Caltrans). El Camino Real (5440 Valley Circle Blvd, inside 91367) served as an American Red Cross shelter during the January 2025 Palisades Fire, taking small animals only. Putting it on the plan in advance saves the first hours of the next evacuation.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: the lead is the county, not the City Emergency Management Department, and shelters are still chosen at the time of each incident, so this is a candidate designation, not a guarantee. Storm closure dates in January and February 2026 and the evacuation zone codes were not verified. One verifier inferred that the Palisades burn scar drains south toward the coast, not into Woodland Hills; that was not confirmed against a USGS debris-flow map.

6. If a home sits where mud or water has come before, buy flood insurance by about 8 November, because it takes 30 days to start and the federal program's authority lapses on 11 December

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED | ECONOMIST | INVENTORY: NOT REACHABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
Households; FEMA's National Flood Insurance Program (NFIP) through any agent	Buy by ~8 Nov	~$1,028 a year all-in at the local average ($772 premium plus fees and surcharges)	Uninsured mudflow and flood losses (standard homeowner policies exclude both)

This ZIP has flooded before. OpenFEMA shows 61 NFIP claims and $530,373 paid here since 1978, of which **23 claims ($137,759) were in 1998**, the last very strong El Niño. Yet only 45 policies were in force on 1 June 2026, all in zone X where lenders do not require cover, and none were tenant policies. NFIP covers mudflow (“a river of liquid and flowing mud”) but **not landslide or other earth movement**. Its authority to write new policies expires on 11 December 2026 unless Congress extends it; it lapsed for 43 days in 2025.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Corrections: $772 is premium only; the all-in average is about $1,028. The post-wildfire exception to the 30-day wait applies only to floods starting on federal land, so it is unlikely to help here. Separately, both California insurance non-renewal moratoria that covered 91367 (Palisades Fire, expired 7 January 2026; Franklin Fire, expired 18 June 2026) have ended; the FAIR Plan, which is fire-only, now holds 696,562 policies (June 2026), up 157% since September 2022.

7. For the hillside streets just south of the ZIP, keep a list of residents who cannot leave quickly and give street-by-street warnings

PARTIALLY CONFIRMED · DEMOTED | EMERGENCY MGR · SKEPTIC · HISTORIAN | INVENTORY: NOT REACHABLE

OWNER	BY WHEN	COST	PREVENTS
LAFD with the Woodland Hills–Warner Center Neighborhood Council	15 Nov	Volunteer time	Night-time evacuations of people who cannot move fast when a slope fails

On 20 March 2011, LAFD evacuated about 12 homes (some 30 people) near 4855 Regalo Road as mud reached a retaining wall, and police reported a second slide on the 5100 block of Baza Avenue. In Montecito in January 2018, debris flows killed 23 people, many of whom stayed home under evacuation warnings that felt routine. Warnings work better when they name the street and are repeated.

Demoted because these streets are most likely in 91364, not 91367 (inferred from the address numbering, not confirmed). Woodland Hills' own risk is ordinary hillside slides, not the post-fire debris flows that Montecito suffered.

Checked and not confirmed, so not recommended here: asking LADWP to replace a 100°F shutoff trigger with NWS heat alerts (LADWP's Rule 11 allows disconnection for nonpayment and states no temperature threshold; the 100°F practice and a 2023 Council motion could not be verified), and LAFD's 25 free sandbags per household from Fire Station 84 (no LAFD page confirmed it; call the station).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

WHO DOES WHAT

RACI CHART

R = Responsible (does the work) · **A** = Accountable (one per action; signs off and answers for it) · **C** = Consulted (asked before) · **I** = Informed (told after). Built from the owners named in the verified actions. No one here has been contacted or has agreed to a role; every row is a proposal.

Action	LA County Public Health	LA City EMD	LA County OEM	County Homeless Services / LAHSA	LAFD	LADWP	ONEgeneration	West Valley Food Pantry	Red Cross / El Camino Real	Neighborhood Council / CD3	Residents
1. Heat check-ins on a named list	**A/R**	**C**		**C**			**R**	**R**		**R**	**R**
2. Cooling reach; LADWP discounts and rebate	**C**	**A/R**	**R**			**R**	**R**			**C**	**R**
3. River-channel outreach; clean-up pause	**C**	**R**	**C**	**A/R**	**R**					**C**	
4. Oxygen and dialysis backup plans	**A/R**				**I**	**C**	**R**				**R**
5. Candidate Topanga receiving shelter		**C**	**A/R**		**C**				**R**	**I**	
6. Flood insurance by ~8 Nov		**I**								**R**	**A/R**
7. Hillside list and street warnings (91364)		**C**			**A/R**					**R**	**R**

What the chart shows. **The top action depends on a data request only the county can make**: without the named emPOWER list, the callers in row 1 are guessing. **Row 3's accountable owner is mid-transition**, from LAHSA to a new county department, during the very winter it must perform. Someone at Council District 3 should confirm, in writing, who answers for the river channel this December.

WHERE MONEY DOES THE MOST

FUNDING

The Philanthropist lens, reconciled against the ranked actions and verified. Placements are ranked by judgement, because no published cost per death averted exists for heat check-ins, storm kits, or bed-nights in Los Angeles. Every unit cost below is an assumption and is labelled as one. The envelope is sized to this ZIP, not to Los Angeles.

FLOOR	TARGET	CEILING	LARGEST UNCERTAINTY
$65k	**$135k**	**$240k**	**Whether a confirmed operator will run phone check-ins, and at what real cost per call**

Floor: check-ins 250 people × $10 × 20 weeks = $50,000 + kits 500 × $30 = $15,000 = **$65,000**. **Target:** 400 × $10 × 20 = $80,000 + 1,000 × $30 = $30,000 + bed-nights 250 × $100 = $25,000 = **$135,000**. **Ceiling:** 600 × $10 × 20 = $120,000 + 2,000 × $30 = $60,000 + 600 × $100 = $60,000 = **$240,000**. **The target fell 27% in verification**, from $185k: the check-in count was sized to the 406 power-dependent residents

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rather than 500, kits were moved to a channel inside the ZIP, and the ceiling was cut from 750 people because one operator without a published call program cannot absorb more. A $30 kit cannot include backup power, so it does not replace action 4.

RECIPIENT	USE	AMOUNT (TARGET)	MECHANISM	BASIS	VERDICT
ONEgeneration (FY to June 2025 revenue $15.98M; federal single audit; names Woodland Hills in its service area)	Action 1 and 4: heat and outage check-ins for ~400 people	$80,000	Restricted grant tied to a count enrolled; pays only for new call and outage-contact work	400 × $10 × 20 weeks (assumed). Duplication risk with its existing alert and Medi-Cal care programs	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
West Valley Food Pantry (5700 Rudnick Ave, 91367; ~15,000 lb of food a week)	Storm and outage kits, delivered on closure days	$30,000 (was $60k via MEND in Pacoima)	In-kind purchase plus delivery	1,000 × $30 (assumed). Church ministry with no 990 found; due diligence still open	PARTIALLY CONFIRMED
County Emergency Response Program shelter	Action 3: bed-nights before storms	$25,000	Paid per verified bed-night; released only when a site is confirmed open	250 × $100 (assumed); no published per-night rate found	CONDITIONAL
Hope of the Valley Rescue Mission (2024 revenue $85.1M)	—	$0	No block grant	Federal audits for FY2022, 2023, and 2024 each flag going-concern doubt and a material weakness (via ProPublica; check fac.gov)	AVOID AS BLOCK GRANTEE

The funder's one thing: the biggest balance sheet in the Valley is the riskiest place for a dollar. Pay mid-sized organisations with clean audits for verified outcomes, a person called or a bed-night used, and ask for the real cost per call before the money moves (ONEgeneration: 818-708-6624).

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

DO NOT DO THIS CONTRAINDICATED

Advice that circulates for this hazard and would cost lives, money, or trust here.

Treat a heat alert or a list of cooling centres as the heat plan

DO NOT DO

US Medicare data show no lower mortality on heat-alert days (RR 1.005), and Los Angeles cooling centres have stood nearly empty during heat waves. Publishing a list leaves the bedbound resident, who has the highest risk, exactly where they were.*

Instead: an alert that triggers a call or a knock on a named list (action 1), and cooling people can reach (action 2).

Say “El Niño is coming, so heat and fire season is over”

DO NOT DO

Woodland Hills set its October record (113°F) on 1 October 2024. In strong El Niño autumns its average October high has been 100°F, the same as in other years, and NOAA favours a warm October–December. The September 2020 heat record and the Palisades Fire of January 2025 both came in La Niña winters, but El Niño years have hot Octobers too. Moving attention to February's rain while October's heat is live could cost more lives than the storms.

Instead: keep heat and Santa Ana readiness running through November and December, and say a wet winter is likely, not certain.

Clear river-channel encampments just before a storm, or give block grants to an organisation with repeated going-concern audit findings

DO NOT DO

People stay in the channel because of their belongings; a clean-up just before a storm removes them and scatters people away from the outreach workers who know where they are. Separately, Hope of the Valley's federal audits flagged going-concern doubt and material weakness three years running; unrestricted money there is the riskiest dollar in the Valley.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

Instead: outreach with storage and beds on a Flood Watch (action 3), and payment per verified bed-night.

WHAT HAS HAPPENED HERE BEFORE — THE RECORD

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Feb–Mar 1938	Los Angeles flood (before ENSO records)	113–115 dead; the San Fernando Valley was LA County's hardest-hit area	Hansen Dam (1940), Sepulveda Dam (1941), and channelisation under the Flood Control Act of 1941
1982–83	Very strong El Niño (ONI 2.14); downtown LA 31.25 in	Not found for this ZIP	—
1997–98	Very strong El Niño (ONI 2.22); downtown LA 31.01 in	23 NFIP claims, $137,759 paid in 91367, the ZIP's worst year	—
2004–05	Weak El Niño (ONI 0.62); downtown LA 37.25 in, second-wettest since 1877	La Conchita slide (Ventura County), 10 dead, 10 Jan 2005	—
20 Mar 2011	Storm mudslides on Regalo Rd and Baza Ave (likely 91364)	~12 homes evacuated	—
2015–16	Super El Niño (ONI 2.50)	Downtown LA 9.65 in, about 68% of normal	—
5–6 Sep 2020	Heat wave; La Niña	121°F at Pierce College, the LA County record	—
Feb–Jun 2024	Atmospheric rivers; El Niño (ONI 1.84)	9 deaths statewide; ~850,000 without power; SR-27 closed 9 Mar – 2 Jun by landslide	—

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

YEAR	EVENT	TOLL	WHAT CHANGED AFTER
Sep–Oct 2024	Heat waves	116–117°F in September; 113°F on 1 Oct, a daily record	—
Jan 2025	Palisades Fire	12 dead; 6,837 structures destroyed; El Camino Real HS used as a Red Cross shelter	SR-27 daytime reopening 4 Mar 2026; $38.5M+ repairs

The recurrence nobody has noticed: the concrete built after 1938 answered the Valley floor's floods. Every disaster here since has come from somewhere that settlement never reached: the canyons, the burn scars, and a September afternoon at Pierce College. And those came in La Niña, neutral, and weak El Niño years as often as in strong ones.

WHERE THE EXPERTS DISAGREE — UNRESOLVED

- **“The heat window is mostly gone by 9 October”** (Philanthropist) versus **“the plan will first be tested by a heat wave”** (Emergency mgr, Skeptic). Verification sided with heat: the October record is 113°F, strong El Niño Octobers are no cooler, and NOAA favours a warm October–December.
- **Hillside mudslides as a headline hazard** (Historian, Emergency mgr) versus **the ZIP being mostly Valley floor** (Frontline, verification). Resolved by demoting the hillside action and naming 91364.
- **ONEgeneration as the check-in operator** (Philanthropist) versus **no published phone-reassurance program** (verification). Unresolved until the organisation confirms it can run one.
- **Whether anyone lives in the river channel inside 91367.** Several lenses assumed so; no verifier found evidence. Ask the county's outreach teams before funding beds here.

WHAT NOBODY COVERED — BLIND SPOT

Santa Ana fire weather and smoke this autumn. Every lens mentioned fire weather, but none verified this October–December's Santa Ana outlook, whether LADWP de-energises lines in high wind, or what a smoke event means for the 406 power-dependent residents who cannot simply open a window. HEPA filters cut indoor fine particles by about 40% (one lens cited Kajbafzadeh et al. 2015), but no trial shows they

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

reduce deaths, so this was not ranked. Nor did any lens look at Warner Center's mid-rise elevators during an outage, which was the dominant problem in San Francisco's December 2025 blackout.

HOW TO READ THIS

METHOD

The panel is author-built. Seven simulated expert lenses were used to generate these recommendations. Where they agree, that is a strong hypothesis, not a consensus of the field. Every recommendation was then independently checked for evidence, transferability to this location, and feasibility before the peak; the verdict tags carry the result.

Mortality figures are resolved at Climate Impact Lab impact-region scale, roughly 300,000 people. They are not neighbourhood figures. The El Niño projection covers *heat only*, which here includes the September–November heat inside its window; flood, mudflow, outages, and cold are additional to it and are carried by the historical record.

HOW THIS BRIEFING WAS PRODUCED

METHODOLOGY

- **Scope.** The request named “Woodland Hills, CA, 91367”. It is treated as ZIP/ZCTA 91367, which is mostly the Valley floor; the hillside streets and the MPTF campus in 91364 are discussed but are outside it. Climate Impact Lab impact region, as the report records it: a Los Angeles County region, *inferred* and not resolved on the Impact Map. Mortality figures exist only at that scale.
- **Exposure.** Climate Impact Lab, *451,000 at Risk* (September 2026, pre-peer-review): ECMWF SEAS5 seasonal forecasts (51-member ensemble) applied to temperature–mortality relationships across 24,378 regions, against a 1996–2025 baseline, for June 2026 – February 2027. It covers heat only. No US figure is published, so none is scaled to this ZIP. It is never added to the Impact Map's long-run projections or quoted from the map's GDP-denominated mortality.
- **Expert panel.** Seven simulated expert lenses (emergency manager, public health scientist, frontline responder, skeptic, economist, historian, and philanthropist) researched this place independently and in parallel, from web sources, to a fixed brief. The brief given to them wrongly dated the county heat record to July 2006; two lenses corrected it to September 2020, and the report uses the correction.
- **Reconciliation.** Duplicate actions were merged and backing lenses recorded. Convergence was tested for shared bias: five lenses converged on heat check-ins, and their evidence includes Los Angeles County's own Medical Examiner data, so it stands; the Chicago and European studies are used only where the local data agree. Contradictions were kept. Actions were ranked by expected lives saved per unit of effort before the peak and reconciled against the funding placements.

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

- **Verification.** Six verifier agents checked 12 recommendations, the historical record, the forecast messaging, the financial instruments, and the funding placements. Verifiers queried HHS emPOWER, OpenFEMA NFIP policies (v3) and claims (v2), the NOAA CPC ONI table and outlooks, RCC-ACIS daily data for the Pierce College station, NWS Los Angeles text products, PubMed, and IRS filings on ProPublica directly. Caltrans' SR-27 pages were fetched by the author after a verifier could not reach them. The envelope was re-summed.
- **Verdicts.** *Confirmed*: evidence, transferability, and feasibility all hold. *Partially confirmed*: holds after the corrections shown. *Unverified*: could not be checked to a primary source. *Contraindicated*: would do harm or waste the window here.
- **Adaptation Inventory.** Not reachable in this run: the page loads its listings by JavaScript, and no verifier could query it. Every action is tagged “not reachable”, which is not the same as “no precedent”.
- **Health wording.** Passages where a wording error could hurt someone (heat and cooling, fans, medical equipment in an outage, and cool places) are marked "* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing." They were checked against published sources, not by a health professional. They are suggestions, not medical advice, and anyone passing them on should confirm them with a doctor, pharmacist, nurse, or community health worker first. The marker was added on 2 November 2026.
- **Rules.** No cost is derived by dividing a published total, and no local figure is invented; where data is thin, the report says so. All unit costs in the envelope are labelled assumptions.
- **Limits.** Nearly every lens and verifier exhausted its web-search budget and worked from directly fetched pages; lacity.gov, laparks.org, and the *Los Angeles Times* returned errors. Unverified and not used: LADWP's heat-shutoff practice, LAFD sandbag details, the ZIP-level language split, the count of older people living alone, any LA River drowning in 2023–25, and a USGS debris-flow map for the Palisades burn scar. The panel and verifiers are AI research agents; no one in Woodland Hills was interviewed.

References · verified by Phase 5 unless marked. NOAA CPC ENSO discussion, 8 Oct 2026 (verified) · NOAA CPC long-lead outlook (verified) · NOAA CPC ONI table (verified) · RCC-ACIS, Woodland Hills Pierce College (049785) (queried) · NWS Los Angeles record report, 1 Oct 2024 (verified) · LA Almanac, downtown LA seasonal rainfall (verified) · Census Reporter, ZCTA 91367 (ACS 2024) (verified) · HHS emPOWER, ZIP layer (queried 9 Oct 2026) · Weinberger et al. 2021, heat alerts and mortality (verified) · Weinberger et al. 2018, 20 cities (verified) · Baker & Sturm 2024, LA County HeatRisk deaths (corrected) · Lin et al. 2024, temperature and homeless deaths (verified) · Bouchama et al. 2007, heat-wave risk factors (verified) · Anderson & Bell 2012, NYC blackout (verified) · West Valley Food Pantry (verified) · ONEgeneration care management (verified) · ONEgeneration, IRS filings (verified) · LA County, heat and augmented cooling centres (verified) · LA Times, cooling centre visitors 2020 (lens) · LAist, cooling centres (lens) · LADWP Cool LA (verified) · LADWP EZ-SAVE (verified) · LADWP Life-Support Equipment discount (verified) · LADWP service rules (verified) · CBS LA, San Gabriel River rescue 2023 (verified) · LAFD, LA River rescue 2024 (verified) · LAHSA Winter Shelter (corrected) · LAHSA Emergency Response Program (verified) · LA County motion, 3 Feb 2026 (verified) · LA County, Shelter in a Storm (2024)

* Suggested formulation: check with a health worker before sharing.

(verified) · Hope of the Valley, IRS filings and audits (verified via ProPublica) · Caltrans, SR-27 landslide 2024 (verified) · Caltrans, SR-27 daytime reopening, Mar 2026 (verified) · CAL FIRE, Palisades Fire shelters (verified) · El Camino Real Charter High School (verified) · CBS LA, Woodland Hills mudslides 2011 (verified) · 2018 Montecito mudflows (secondary) · OpenFEMA NFIP policies (v3) (queried) · OpenFEMA NFIP claims (v2) (queried) · FEMA, mudflow and the NFIP (verified) · CRS, NFIP reauthorization (Sep 2026) (verified) · California Department of Insurance bulletins (verified) · California FAIR Plan statistics (verified) · 1938 Los Angeles flood (secondary) · February 2024 atmospheric rivers (secondary) · 2005 La Conchita landslide (secondary) · Palisades Fire (secondary)

Exposure data · Climate Impact Lab, 451,000 at Risk · Impact Map · Adaptation Inventory

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